

Shipment Escalation SOP

Standard Operating Procedure for Logistics & Shipment Issue Escalation

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1. Purpose and Scope

This SOP defines the standard process for identifying, tracking, and escalating delayed, damaged, lost, or misrouted shipments handled by or on behalf of TechCorp India. It applies to all shipments moving into, out of, or between TechCorp India offices, including client deliverables, inbound procurement consignments, and inter-office transfers. The objective is to ensure that any shipment issue is detected early, communicated transparently, and resolved within a predictable timeline, minimizing business impact to clients and internal teams.

This document applies to the Logistics Coordination team, Procurement, Facilities, Project Delivery Managers, and any employee who initiates or receives a tracked shipment on company account. It does not cover personal courier use or reimbursement claims, which are governed separately under the Travel & Expense Policy.

2. Shipment Categories

All shipments tracked under this SOP fall into one of three categories. The category determines the urgency weighting applied during escalation and the stakeholders who must be notified.

Category	Description	Urgency Weighting
Client Deliverables	Hardware, signed contracts, certified documents, branded collateral, or equipment shipped directly to a client site or client-designated address.	Highest — client-facing impact, contractual SLAs may apply
Inbound Procurement	Laptops, peripherals, office supplies, networking equipment, and vendor deliveries arriving at any TechCorp India office from external vendors.	Medium-High — affects onboarding, project readiness, asset provisioning
Inter-Office Transfer	Assets, documents, or equipment moved between TechCorp India branches (e.g., Bengaluru to Pune, Hyderabad to Noida).	Medium — internal impact, generally more flexible timelines

3. SLA Definitions and Delay Triggers

Each shipment category carries a defined Service Level Agreement (SLA) measured from the date of dispatch confirmation. A shipment is automatically flagged as "At Risk" or "Delayed" when it crosses the thresholds below, triggering the escalation workflow described in Section 4.

Category	Standard SLA	Delay Trigger Condition
Client Deliverables	1–2 business days (metro) 3–4 business days (non-metro/remote)	No tracking update for 24 hrs, or ETA missed by 4+ hrs
Inbound Procurement	3–5 business days (domestic) 7–12 business days (import/cross-border)	No movement update for 48 hrs, or customs hold exceeding 24 hrs
Inter-Office Transfer	2–4 business days	No movement update for 48 hrs, or missed branch handoff window

Delay Trigger Rule: A shipment that breaches its SLA window automatically moves to "Delayed" status in the tracking sheet and must be escalated to L1 Operations within 2 business hours of the breach being detected.

4. Escalation Tiers

Escalation follows a strict three-tier structure. Each tier has a defined response window; if the issue is not resolved or acknowledged within that window, it auto-escalates to the next tier. No shipment issue may bypass L1 unless it falls under the Critical severity definition in Section 5.

Tier	Role	Responsibilities	Response Window
L1	Operations Executive (Logistics Coordination)	First point of contact. Verifies tracking status, contacts courier partner, logs the issue, attempts direct resolution (re-routing, redelivery request).	4 business hours
L2	Logistics Manager	Engages courier account manager directly, authorizes alternate shipping methods, communicates with affected internal stakeholders (PM/client-facing teams), approves minor cost overruns for expedited resolution.	8 business hours
L3	VP – Operations	Engages courier partner leadership for high-value or client-critical shipments, approves compensation/replacement procurement, communicates with client account owners if a contractual SLA is breached, signs off on root cause report.	24 business hours

Auto-escalation rule: If L1 does not log a resolution update within the 4-hour window, the ticket automatically reassigns to L2 with a system-generated notification. The same rule applies from L2 to L3. Manual escalation directly to L3 is permitted only for shipments classified as Critical severity (see Section 5) or when the client has directly raised the concern.

5. Severity Classification

Severity	Classification Criteria	Handling
Critical	Client deliverable tied to a contractual milestone; or shipment value exceeding Rs. 2,00,000; or security/compliance-sensitive cargo (e.g., signed legal documents).	Immediate L2 notification; L3 informed within 2 hours
High	Client deliverable with no contractual milestone but client awaiting confirmation; inbound procurement blocking a confirmed joiner's start date.	Standard L1 → L2 → L3 escalation path
Standard	Inter-office transfers; non-urgent procurement; routine documentation.	Standard escalation path, relaxed response windows by 50%

6. Timeline Summary

The table below summarizes the end-to-end escalation timeline from issue detection to resolution sign-off, assuming the issue is not resolved at an earlier stage.

Timestamp	Milestone	Owner
T+0	SLA breach detected (system flag or manual report)	Tracking System / Reporter
T+0 to T+2 hrs	Issue logged, assigned ticket ID, initial courier contact made	L1 Operations

Timestamp	Milestone	Owner
T+4 hrs	L1 resolution window closes; auto-escalates to L2 if unresolved	System
T+4 to T+12 hrs	Courier account-level escalation, alternate logistics arranged	L2 Logistics Manager
T+12 hrs	L2 resolution window closes; auto-escalates to L3 if unresolved	System
T+12 to T+36 hrs	Senior courier escalation, client communication, compensation approval	L3 VP Operations
T+36 to T+48 hrs	Resolution confirmed; root cause analysis initiated	L1 + L2 jointly
T+72 hrs	Root cause report submitted and signed off	L2 (drafted), L3 (approved)

7. Root Cause Analysis (RCA) Requirements

Every shipment issue that escalates beyond L1, or that results in financial loss, client communication, or replacement procurement, requires a documented Root Cause Analysis. The RCA must be filed within 72 hours of resolution and stored in the Logistics Incident Log.

7.1 Mandatory RCA Fields

- Ticket ID, shipment category, courier partner, and origin–destination pair
- Timeline of events with timestamps at each escalation tier
- Root cause classification (courier-side, address/documentation error, customs/regulatory, weather/force majeure, internal process gap, vendor packaging failure)
- Financial impact, if any (replacement cost, expedited shipping premium, client credit issued)
- Corrective action taken and preventive action proposed
- Sign-off from L2 (preparer) and L3 (approver)

7.2 RCA Review Cadence

All RCAs are reviewed in the monthly Logistics Performance Review chaired by the VP – Operations. Recurring root causes (3 or more occurrences in a quarter tied to the same courier partner or process step) trigger a mandatory vendor performance review or internal process audit.

8. Courier Issue Handling Matrix

The matrix below provides the first-response action for the most common courier-side issues encountered. L1 Operations should reference this table before escalating, as many issues can be resolved without involving L2.

Issue Scenario	First-Response Action	Owner
Tracking shows no update for 24+ hrs	Contact courier helpline with AWB/tracking number; request manual status check from regional hub	L1
Package marked "delivered" but not received	Request delivery proof (signature/photo) from courier; verify with site security/reception; raise claim if unconfirmed within 4 hrs	L1
Customs hold (import shipments)	Retrieve customs reference number; coordinate with customs broker; escalate to L2 if hold exceeds 24 hrs	L1 → L2
Damaged shipment on arrival	Photograph damage immediately, do not discard packaging, file courier damage claim within 24 hrs, notify L2 for replacement procurement	L1 → L2

Issue Scenario	First-Response Action	Owner
Misrouted to wrong branch/address	Confirm correct address with courier, request redirection; if redirection unavailable, arrange local pickup or reshipment	L1
Lost shipment (no movement 5+ days)	File formal loss claim with courier, notify L2 immediately, initiate replacement procurement in parallel	L2 → L3
Courier requests additional documents (KYC/customs)	Coordinate with Procurement/Compliance to furnish documents within 24 hrs to avoid return-to-origin	L1
Recipient unavailable for delivery (3 failed attempts)	Reschedule via courier app/portal; provide alternate contact; escalate if 4th attempt also fails	L1 → L2

9. Roles and Responsibilities Summary

Role	Responsibility
Operations Executive (L1)	Daily tracking monitoring, first-response courier contact, ticket logging, status updates to requester
Logistics Manager (L2)	Courier account management, alternate logistics arrangement, cost-overrun approval up to Rs. 15,000 per incident, stakeholder communication
VP – Operations (L3)	Final escalation authority, client-facing communication for breached SLAs, RCA approval, courier partner contract review
Project/Delivery Manager	Flags client-impacting shipments early, provides delivery context, communicates timeline risk to client where applicable
Procurement Team	Supports replacement orders for lost/damaged shipments, manages vendor documentation for customs-held inbound shipments

10. Contact Directory

The following contacts should be used for all shipment escalations. For after-hours critical escalations, contact the on-call Logistics Manager via the number listed below.

Contact Point	Name / Team	Email	Phone	Availability
L1 — Logistics Helpdesk	Operations Team	logistics.helpdesk@techcorpindia.com	+91 80 4567 1010	Mon–Sat, 9:00–19:00 IST
L2 — Logistics Manager	Rohan Deshmukh	rohan.deshmukh@techcorpindia.com	+91 98450 22317	Mon–Sat, 9:00–20:00 IST
L2 — On-Call (After Hours)	Logistics Duty Line	logistics.oncall@techcorpindia.com	+91 90080 17744	24x7 for Critical severity only
L3 — VP, Operations	Anjali Krishnamurthy	anjali.krishnamurthy@techcorpindia.com	+91 98200 55612	Escalation only, via L2
Procurement Liaison	Vendor & Asset Desk	procurement.assets@techcorpindia.com	+91 80 4567 1022	Mon–Fri, 9:30–18:30 IST
Courier Partner — BlueDart	Corporate Account Desk	corporate.support@bluedart-acct.example	1800-22-4567	24x7 (corporate line)
Courier Partner — Delhivery	Enterprise Support	enterprise.support@delhivery-acct.example	1800-208-1900	Mon–Sat, 8:00–22:00 IST
Customs Broker (Imports)	Mehta Clearing Agency	ops@mehtaclearing.example	+91 22 6781 4400	Mon–Sat, 9:00–18:00 IST

This SOP is reviewed annually by the Logistics & Facilities Department or upon material change in courier partnerships. Last reviewed: April 2026. Next scheduled review: April 2027.